



*Nathan Hillyer  
Director of Engineering  
ForeFlight  
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To Whom It May Concern,

I recommend Ethan for any opportunity he seeks to pursue. During his summer internship with our team in 2024, Ethan distinguished himself as an incredibly talented and dedicated individual. He contributed significantly to our projects and left a lasting positive impact on our team.

One of Ethan's key contributions was his work on implementing a new synchronization API using a UI paradigm called UITableViewDiffableDataSource, a feature new to our company. He was the first to utilize this paradigm, and his innovative approach paved the way for its future use within our product. His ability to quickly grasp new technologies and apply them in practical, real-world scenarios was a testament to his adaptability and technical expertise.

Ethan's productivity and enthusiasm were unmatched. Throughout the summer, he juggled multiple tasks and projects, all of which he completed with impressive quality and efficiency. He never let the demands of his workload diminish his positivity, and his energy uplifted the team. Ethan's ability to maintain high output while staying grounded and approachable made him a pleasure to work with.

His leadership and willingness to tackle complex challenges head-on set Ethan apart. In one instance, we encountered unexpected complexity while developing an API to store the initial state of synced objects for delta diffing. Ethan identified a solution by creatively serializing the initial state as JSON, effectively overcoming Swift compiler typing issues. His resourcefulness and problem-solving ability demonstrated his technical acumen and resilience in facing challenges.

On a personal level, Ethan exemplified professionalism. He was always punctual, prepared, and eager to contribute. He knew when to ask insightful questions and when to independently seek solutions, a skill that is often difficult to master, even for seasoned engineers. His positive attitude and humility helped cultivate a collaborative and supportive team culture.

I do not doubt that Ethan has a bright future ahead of him. He combines technical prowess with a strong work ethic and personal attributes—humility, leadership, and positivity—that make him a standout individual in any setting. If given the opportunity, I would hire Ethan full-time without hesitation. However, I am equally excited to see him continue his academic journey and look forward to witnessing his future success.

Please contact me if you have any questions or want further details about Ethan's contributions and strengths.

Sincerely,

Nathan Hillyer

Director of Engineering

[nathan@foreflight.com](mailto:nathan@foreflight.com)